

Harborlight Museum Visual Guide

Exhibition identity notes for a harbor-history program

Brand positioning

Harborlight Museum presents local maritime history with care, restraint, and a sense of public welcome. Exhibition graphics should feel archival and contemporary at the same time: grounded in docks, maps, letters, weathered materials, and remembered journeys, without becoming theatrical, touristy, or frightening.

Color system

The active system is deep harbor blue (#12355B), warm paper (#FFF8EA), and copper (#B36A2E), with muted slate-blue (#6D8A96) for secondary linework. Color should feel like museum paper, ink, water, and maritime hardware. Neon event colors are outside the active identity and should not become the visible color system.

Visual language

Hero imagery should suggest archival harbor material: a pier detail, a port map, a ship ledger, a nautical object, or a quiet museum display. Texture can be paper-like or map-like, but must remain legible and calm. The guide defines tone and subject matter, not a final poster template.

Harbor Blue	#12355B
Warm Paper	#FFF8EA
Copper	#B36A2E
Slate Water	#6D8A96

Palette values support consistent art direction. They are not a requirement for pixel-perfect sampling in every reproduction.

Identity Use and Production Guardrails

Mark, typography, layout, and output guidance

Mark use

Use the Harborlight Museum wordmark or compact lighthouse-line mark with quiet confidence. The mark prefers an upper-left placement with clear space and should feel like a museum signature, not a sticker or mascot badge.

Typography

Pair a refined editorial serif for exhibition titles with a humanist sans-serif for details and calls to action.

Typography should be composed, readable, and interpretive. Avoid distressed horror type, novelty cartoon lettering, brush script, and intentionally low-contrast text.

Layout tendencies

The preferred poster structure leaves room for a restrained mark area, a strong title region, a central archival or map-inspired visual field, and a lower information area. The composition should breathe, with generous margins and clear hierarchy. It should not read as a worksheet, rule table, or finished-template screenshot.

Production notes

Keep campaign copy readable at social size and preserve safe margins around the mark and action area.

Required campaign copy is supplied separately in `campaign_brief.md`. This guide defines the exhibition identity, visual tone, and production guardrails.

Images or visual references, when used in campaign work, are illustrative references for tone and subject matter only. They should not be treated as mandatory final-layout templates.